

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
FOR ENGROSSED
SENATE BILL NO. 1726

By: Daniels of the Senate

and

Caldwell (Chad) of the
House

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to higher education; requiring institutions of higher education utilizing graduate students as instructors to establish and maintain training for graduate student instructors; providing for contents of training; providing for codification; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3235 of Title 70, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. An institution of higher education within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education utilizing graduate students as instructors of record or as primary classroom instructors in

1 undergraduate courses shall establish and maintain a formal training
2 program to ensure such graduate instructors are adequately prepared
3 for their instructional responsibilities.

4 B. The training required by subsection A of this section shall
5 include effective teaching practices, classroom management,
6 assessment and grading standards, student accommodations, academic
7 integrity, and applicable institutional, state, and federal
8 policies. The training shall also include instruction on the
9 protection of students' rights under the First Amendment to the
10 United States Constitution including the principles of free speech,
11 free inquiry, and viewpoint neutrality. The training shall
12 emphasize that students shall not be penalized or disadvantaged in
13 grading, participation, or evaluation on the basis of lawful
14 expression.

15 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

16 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
17 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
18 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
19 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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